Indian Knowledge Systems - Solved Question Papers

MBA Semester I (2024 Pattern) | Paper 1: [6430]-508 | Paper 2: [6380]-5008

PAPER 1 : [6430]-508 | IKS-508-MJ-GC-08 Indian Knowledge Systems

Q1) Attempt any five (2 marks each) - all eight solved

a) Describe the significance of self-awareness in leadership from the Bhagavad Gita.

In the Gita, Arjuna was confused on the battlefield because he did not know his own duty and strengths. Krishna teaches that a leader must first know his true self (*Atma-jnana*) and say 'lift yourself by your own self' (Gita 6.5). Self-awareness helps a leader to control emotions, know his *svadharma* (duty), act without ego and take right decisions; a leader who conquers his mind can lead others.

b) Elaborate 'Servant leadership'.

Servant leadership was introduced by Robert K. Greenleaf (1970). Here the leader's first aim is to **serve the followers**, and leading comes second. The leader puts the needs, growth and well-being of team members before his own, with listening, empathy, healing, foresight, stewardship and community building. It is similar to the Indian idea of *seva* and *lokasangraha*. Example: Mahatma Gandhi; Ratan Tata caring for employees.

c) What is 'Egalitarianism' in western management theories?

Egalitarianism is the belief that all people are equal and should get equal rights, opportunities and respect. In western management it means a **flat structure with few levels, participative decision making, open communication and less status difference** between managers and employees (as in Google, Valve, Netflix). Opposite is hierarchy.

d) What is Jugaad innovation and why is it important in Indian businesses?

Jugaad is a Hindi word meaning an **innovative, low-cost, flexible and improvised solution** to a problem, made with limited resources ('make do'). It is an Indian style of frugal innovation, in which ordinary people find a quick workable fix. Examples: a motorised cart made with a water pump engine, **Mitticool** (clay refrigerator made by Mansukhbhai Prajapati of Gujarat), Tata Nano, Godrej ChotuKool.

Importance: resource constraints in India make low-cost, quick and flexible solutions necessary; it helps reach low-income consumers, creates employment, and saves cost and time (frugal innovation).

e) How does Shivaji Maharaj's leadership reflect resilience in adversity?

Shivaji started with very few resources against powerful Adilshahi, Mughal and Siddi forces. After the Treaty of Purandar (1665) he lost many forts and was held at Agra by Aurangzeb, but he escaped cleverly in 1666, regained forts, and was crowned Chhatrapati in 1674. He used guerrilla warfare (*Ganimi Kava*), forts and spy network, and never gave up, showing courage, patience, flexibility and a strong vision of Swarajya.

f) What are the key differences between holistic and analytical decision making?

Holistic decision making	Analytical decision making
Looks at the whole system and relationships	Breaks the problem into parts
Uses intuition, experience, values and context	Uses data, logic, models and quantitative tools
Qualitative, long-term, flexible (Indian / Eastern approach)	Quantitative, step-by-step, structured (Western approach)
Considers ethics, society and nature together	Focuses on measurable economic outcomes

g) Discuss the role of social enterprises in local communities.

Social enterprises are businesses with a social mission, which reinvest profits to solve social problems. Role in local communities: **create employment and livelihood** (especially for women and the poor), provide **affordable health, education and finance**, use local resources and skills, promote **local development and sustainability**, and empower communities. Examples: Amul (dairy cooperative), Aravind Eye Care, SEWA, Goonj, Selco.

h) What are the Vedas and how do they contribute to Indian Knowledge Systems (IKS)?

The Vedas are the oldest sacred texts of India, a source of knowledge (*Veda* = knowledge): **Rigveda, Yajurveda, Samaveda and Atharvaveda**. They contain hymns, rituals, philosophy (Upanishads) and knowledge of astronomy, medicine (Ayurveda), music, ethics and society. They contribute to IKS by giving concepts of *Dharma, Rta* (cosmic order), *Karma, Yajna* (collective sacrifice and sharing), holistic living, and the foundation of Indian science, philosophy and values-based management.

Q2) Attempt any two (5 marks each) - all three solved

a) How do the teachings of the Gita address team dynamics in a high-performance environment?

- **Common purpose and Lokasangraha:** work for the welfare of all; the team should have a shared vision (Gita 3.20, 3.25).
- **Nishkama karma:** focus on effort, not on personal reward (2.47). Reduces ego conflict, jealousy and unhealthy competition.
- **Svadharma and role clarity:** each member has his own natural duty and strength (Gita 3.35, 18.41-44 on varna by guna and karma). Right person at the right role improves performance.
- **Equanimity (Samatvam):** treat success and failure alike (2.48); the team stays calm under pressure.
- **Leader as role model:** 'whatever a great person does, others follow' (3.21). A leader should lead by example.
- **Dialogue and listening:** Krishna patiently answers Arjuna's doubts - open communication; **Yajna spirit:** sharing and cooperation among members.

b) Provide an example of how Shivaji Maharaj's leadership in adversity can inspire modern leaders.

Example: Escape from Agra (1666) and revival of Swarajya. After the Treaty of Purandar, Shivaji went to Aurangzeb's court at Agra and was put under house arrest. Instead of losing hope, he planned carefully, pretended to be ill, sent sweets baskets for donation and escaped in one of them, reached Raigad safely, and within few years recovered the forts and was crowned in 1674.

- **Lesson 1 - Resilience and a positive attitude:** a setback is not the end; a leader must recover fast.
- **Lesson 2 - Creative thinking (jugaad):** using few resources cleverly in a crisis.
- **Lesson 3 - Strategic patience and planning:** he signed the treaty to save people and bought time to rebuild.
- **Lesson 4 - Trusted team and intelligence network** (Bahirji Naik's spy system), which modern leaders correspond to as information and loyal teams.

Modern leaders (startups, CEOs in crisis, such as turnaround of a failing company) can apply these lessons.

c) Explain the role of intuition and gut feeling in decision making as emphasised in Indian knowledge systems. How does this differ from data-driven decision making in western management?

Intuition is the ability to understand or know something immediately, without conscious step-by-step reasoning, based on experience, insight and inner wisdom. **Indian knowledge systems** give importance to intuition: it is linked with *Viveka* (discrimination), *Prajna* (wisdom), *Antar-jnana* / *Pratibha* (inner knowing) and *Buddhi* (the intellect purified by meditation). Gita says a person of steady wisdom (*Sthitaprajna*) with a calm mind takes right decisions; Vedanta and yoga advise self-awareness, meditation and sattvic mind for intuitive clarity. Great decisions of Shivaji or Indian traders were often made on the basis of experience, instinct and understanding of people.

Basis	Intuition / gut feeling (IKS)	Data-driven decision making (Western management)
Basis of decision	Experience, inner wisdom, holistic understanding, values	Facts, statistics, models and analytics
Process	Quick, non-linear, subconscious	Systematic, logical, step by step
Focus	Whole situation, context, relationship, ethics (dharma)	Parts, numbers, measurable variables
Strength	Speed, useful in uncertainty and when data is not available; creativity	Objective, reduces bias, can be tested and explained
Weakness	Subjective, can be biased, hard to justify or teach	Slow, costly; needs reliable data; may ignore human factors

Conclusion: The best decisions combine both: use data to test, and intuition (trained by experience and ethics) to give direction.

Q3) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Explain how developing resilience and emotional intelligence as the Bhagavad Gita teaches can inspire and motivate teams in an organisational setting.

Resilience is the ability to bounce back from setbacks. **Emotional intelligence (EI)** is the ability to understand and manage one's own emotions and those of others (Goleman: self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills). The Gita, through Krishna's counselling of the confused Arjuna, gives a practical model for both.

Gita teachings for resilience

- **Equanimity in pain and pleasure, success and failure** (2.14, 2.38, 2.48): 'Samatvam yoga uchyate'. Pain and pleasure come and go; one should bear them.
- **Detachment from results - Nishkama karma** (2.47): focus on effort, which gives freedom from fear of failure.
- **Stand up and act** ('Uttishtha'): do not become weak-hearted (2.3); persistence and courage.
- **Sthitaprajna** (2.55-72): the person of steady wisdom, unmoved by adversity.

Gita teachings for emotional intelligence

- **Self-awareness and self-regulation:** 'Uddhared atmanatmanam' (6.5) - raise yourself by your own mind; mind can be a friend or an enemy; control of anger, greed and desire (2.62-63, 16.21).
- **Empathy and compassion:** seeing all beings with equal vision (5.18, 6.32), kindness and friendliness (12.13).
- **Social skills:** Krishna listens, explains with reason and gives freedom of choice ('do as you wish', 18.63) - a model of coaching leadership.

Application in an organisation

1. A leader who stays calm in crisis (layoffs, losses) gives confidence to the team.
2. Setting process-oriented goals reduces fear and stress; employees try new things and learn from failure.
3. Empathetic listening, one-to-one coaching and recognition build trust and motivation.
4. Training programmes with meditation and yoga, mindfulness, EI workshops improve well-being and reduce burnout.
5. Ethical, selfless work and purpose (lokasangraha) increase intrinsic motivation and teamwork.

Result: teams become resilient, motivated, collaborative and perform better in uncertain environments.

b) Analyse how the principles of Karma and Dharma could be applied in modern western corporations to enhance work-life balance and ethical practices.

Karma means action and the law that every action has its consequences; the Gita's *Karma Yoga* = performing duty without attachment to results. **Dharma** means righteous duty, ethics, and the principle that sustains society.

Principle	Application for work-life balance	Application for ethical practice
Karma (action and consequence)	Focus on quality of effort rather than long hours and constant worry; accept that rest and family are also part of karma; reduces stress and burnout	Every decision has an effect on stakeholders, so avoid short-cuts (fraud, mis-selling); accountability, as 'as you sow, so you reap' (e.g. Enron, Volkswagen emission scandal)
Nishkama karma (selfless action)	Do the duty well and do not link self-worth only with promotions or bonus	Avoids greed and unethical pressure to meet targets at any cost
Dharma (duty, ethics)	Dharma includes duty to family, self and society, so a balanced 'ashrama' life; policies like flexible work, leave, wellness	Code of conduct, integrity, fair treatment, CSR, transparency and sustainability; 'stakeholder dharma' (employees, customers, society, environment)
Svadharma (own role)	Right person in the right job with autonomy reduces stress	Each employee takes responsibility for his role, speaks up against wrong (whistle-blowing)
Raj dharma / leader's dharma	Leaders model balance (not sending midnight emails)	Leaders set an ethical tone from the top

Steps for western corporations

- Include values-based training, mindfulness, and ethics modules; link performance evaluation to ethical conduct and not only profit.
- Adopt flexible work, wellness and employee assistance programmes; right to disconnect.
- Create an ethics committee and whistle-blower policy; reward ethical behaviour.

Conclusion: Karma and Dharma give a universal, value-based framework which can reduce stress and improve ethics, if applied as practical policies and not as religion.

Q4) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Evaluate the role of community support in the sustainability of family-owned business in India, highlighting key challenges and opportunities.

In India, family business is deeply connected with the **community** (caste/regional communities like Marwaris, Gujaratis, Parsis, Chettiars, Sindhis, and local villages). Community support has been a key reason for the survival of many family businesses.

Role of community support

- **Financial support:** informal credit, community lending (e.g. Chettiar banking), and shared capital at low cost; chit funds.
- **Trust and social capital:** business done on reputation and word of mouth; low transaction cost and contract enforcement through social pressure.
- **Market and customer base:** loyal local customers and community network for supply and distribution.
- **Talent and labour:** trusted employees and apprentices from the community; skills pass from generation to generation.
- **Information, mentoring and guidance** from elders; collective values (honesty, thrift, *seva*) and social security in a crisis.
- **Reputation / legitimacy:** support in times of crisis, and help in disputes by community elders.

Challenges

- Nepotism, and favouring community members over talent; resistance to outsiders and professionals.
- Conservatism and slow adoption of technology; difficulty in modernising and scaling up.
- Family disputes; community pressure on succession; limited growth beyond the community.
- Changing values of the young generation, migration to cities, and competition from corporates and e-commerce.

Opportunities

- Using community networks for digital marketplaces, crowdfunding and angel networks; strong brand value of 'trusted local business'.
- Government schemes (MSME, Start-up India, Mudra); export opportunities via diaspora networks.
- Social enterprises and CSR with the community; sustainability and local sourcing, which suit the community-based model.

Evaluation: Community support gives resilience, but for long-term sustainability family businesses must professionalise, innovate and open up to outsiders while keeping their values.

b) Describe in detail the principles and practices of jugaad innovation, emphasising its importance in resource-limited environments.

Jugaad is a Hindi word meaning an **innovative, low-cost, flexible and improvised solution** to a problem, made with limited resources ('make do'). It is an Indian style of frugal innovation, in which ordinary people find a quick workable fix. Examples: a motorised cart made with a water pump engine, **Mitticool** (clay refrigerator made by Mansukhbhai Prajapati of Gujarat), Tata Nano, Godrej ChotuKool.

Principles

Navi Radjou, Jaideep Prabhu and Simone Ahuja describe six principles of jugaad innovation:

1. **Seek opportunity in adversity:** see problems and scarcity as a chance to innovate (e.g. Tata Swach water purifier for low-income homes).
2. **Do more with less:** create more value using fewer resources; frugal thinking (e.g. ChotuKool, a battery-run small fridge at a low price).

3. **Think and act flexibly:** adapt quickly to changing situations and use trial and error, without long planning.
4. **Keep it simple:** simple, easy-to-use and low-cost products and processes (e.g. Nokia basic phones, Tata Nano).
5. **Include the margin:** design for the low-income and neglected consumers (the 'bottom of the pyramid'), e.g. Aravind Eye Care, microfinance.
6. **Follow your heart:** trust one's intuition and passion; entrepreneurs act on their conviction.

Practices

- Using locally available and recycled materials; modifying existing products (repurposing), e.g. converting motorcycle engines into pumps or carts.
- Rapid prototyping, trial and error and learning by doing; collaboration with local craftsmen and users (co-creation).
- Low-cost, modular and multi-use designs; sharing of assets (autorickshaw sharing, tiffin dabbawalas).
- Frugal business models: pay-per-use, micro-packets (sachets for shampoo), low-cost healthcare (Aravind Eye, Narayana Health), Jaipur Foot.

Importance in resource-limited environments

- Provides affordable solutions to the poor and rural markets; gives livelihood and jobs.
- Fast solution without large R&D budget; less wastage, sustainable.
- Develops entrepreneurial spirit and creativity; provides competitive advantage and a base for 'reverse innovation' (Indian frugal products sold in developed markets).

Limitations

Quality, safety and standards may be compromised; difficult to scale and patent; sometimes short-term fix. So jugaad should be combined with systematic and quality processes.

Q5) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Discuss Shivaji Maharaj's role as a nation builder and entrepreneur. How did his innovation strategies in governance and warfare contribute to building a resilient and prosperous state?

Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj (1630-1680) founded the *Hindavi Swarajya* (self-rule) and was crowned at Raigad in 1674. He was both a nation builder (state, institutions, identity) and an entrepreneur (vision, risk taking, resource mobilisation, innovation).

Nation builder

- Created a people-centred state with the idea of *Swarajya* and justice, protecting farmers, women and all religions; strict action against misuse of power.
- Built a strong administration, a well-organised army and navy, and a system of forts that gave long-term security.

Innovation in governance

- **Ashta Pradhan Mandal:** council of eight ministers (Peshwa, Amatya, Sachiv, etc.) with defined roles - delegation and decentralisation.
- **Revenue reforms:** abolished the Jagirdari / middlemen system, direct collection from cultivators by salaried officials, fixed assessment based on land survey; loan and seeds to farmers in bad years.
- **Salaried army and officials** (paid in cash/grants; no hereditary jagirs) - reduces corruption; merit-based appointments (e.g. Tanaji, Baji Prabhu).
- **Use of Marathi and Sanskrit in administration** (Rajvyavahar Kosh); the royal seal; coins (Shivrai); a good intelligence system (Bahirji Naik).
- **Trade and economy:** promoted trade and ports, customs, protected merchants, and encouraged shipbuilding.

Innovation in warfare

- **Guerrilla warfare (Ganimi Kava):** surprise attacks, speed and use of terrain of Sahyadri against large armies (Afzal Khan at Pratapgad, 1659; Shaista Khan at Pune; Pavankhind, Surat raid).
- **Forts:** over 300 forts, with a command system and rule that no single person controls a fort; **navy** at Kolaba, Sindhudurg and Vijaydurg - the first Indian ruler to build a naval force to protect the coast.
- Light cavalry and infantry (Mavle), a disciplined army with strict code of conduct and respect for civilians.

Entrepreneurial qualities

- Vision, risk-taking, resource mobilisation from small base, innovation, team building (talent selection), adaptability (diplomacy with Mughals and Adilshahi when necessary) and customer (people) orientation.

Conclusion: Shivaji's strategies built a resilient state with efficient governance, economic prosperity and strong defence; his model is still relevant for modern leadership and management.

b) Discuss how traditional family and community business practices can be adapted to modern business environments, particularly in light of technology and globalisation. Provide examples of successful adaptation strategies.

Traditional practices (trust-based dealings, joint family capital, apprenticeship, community networks, frugality, long-term relationships, *bahi-khata* accounting) have strengths, but they must adapt to technology and globalisation.

Traditional practice	Adaptation for modern environment	Example
Trust and word-of-mouth	Online reviews, branding and digital marketing, while keeping trust and quality as the core	Haldiram's, Patanjali, Dabur - strong brand plus e-commerce
Bahi-khata / manual accounts	Tally, ERP, GST software, digital payments	Small traders using Tally, UPI, Paytm
Informal family management	Professional managers, governance, family constitution, board	Tata Sons, Godrej, Mahindra
Local market and limited scale	E-commerce platforms and exports; global supply chains	Artisans selling on Amazon/Flipkart/Etsy; Kolhapuri chappals, Bandhani export
Community credit (informal lending)	Fintech, bank loans, venture capital, crowdfunding	Marwari trading families raising PE funds, IPOs (e.g. Bajaj, Dabur)
Apprenticeship and skill passed on orally	Formal training, skill development, digital tools; MBA in the next generation	Family firms sending heirs for management education
Frugality and jugaad	Frugal innovation and lean operations	Tata Nano, ChotuKool, Amul
Dabbawala and cooperative systems	Technology to improve efficiency and scale	Mumbai dabbawalas using SMS/app booking; Amul's digital milk collection

Strategy summary: keep core values (trust, ethics, long-term view, community), but adopt technology, professional management, innovation, global networks and succession planning. Reliance (textile to Jio), Bajaj Auto, Amul and Tanishq (Tata) show successful adaptation.

PAPER 2 : [6380]-5008 | 108-GC-08 Indian Knowledge Systems

Q1) Attempt any five (2 marks each) - all eight solved

a) Elaborate the role of value in decision making.

Values (honesty, fairness, responsibility, compassion, dharma) are the beliefs about what is right and wrong. In decision making they **act as a filter and a guide**: they decide the objectives and the alternatives that are acceptable, ensure ethical and socially responsible decisions, build trust and reputation, and resolve conflict between short-term profit and long-term good. Value-based decisions are sustainable (e.g. Tata's decisions in crisis and Johnson & Johnson's Tylenol recall).

b) Define Karma.

Karma means **action or duty**. In Indian philosophy, it is the law that every action has a result (as you sow, so you reap). The Gita teaches *Karma Yoga*: perform your duty with full effort without attachment to the fruits (2.47).

c) What is Good Governance?

Good governance is the process of running an organisation or government in a way that is **transparent, accountable, ethical, participatory, responsive, efficient and follows the rule of law**, so that resources are used properly and the interests of all stakeholders are protected. Indian idea: *Raj dharma* and 'Ram Rajya'.

d) What is Work ethics?

Work ethics are the **moral principles and values that guide a person's behaviour at work**: honesty, integrity, discipline, punctuality, responsibility, respect, commitment and quality. In India, it is related to the idea 'work is worship' (*Karma is dharma*).

e) Define Jugaad.

Jugaad is a Hindi word meaning an **innovative, low-cost, flexible and improvised solution** to a problem, made with limited resources ('make do'). It is an Indian style of frugal innovation, in which ordinary people find a quick workable fix. Examples: a motorised cart made with a water pump engine, **Mitticool** (clay refrigerator made by Mansukhbhai Prajapati of Gujarat), Tata Nano, Godrej ChotuKool.

f) What is succession planning?

Succession planning is the **process of identifying and developing future leaders** (internal talent) to fill key positions when the current holders retire, resign or leave, so that the organisation continues smoothly. It is very important in family businesses (e.g. Ratan Tata to N. Chandrasekaran).

g) Name any two leadership styles.

- Autocratic leadership
- Democratic (participative) leadership (others: laissez-faire, transformational, servant leadership)

h) List leadership traits of Shivaji Maharaj.

- Visionary (Swarajya), courage and determination
- Strategic and creative thinker (guerrilla warfare); resilience in adversity
- Excellent organiser and administrator; delegation (Ashta Pradhan)
- Justice, ethical conduct and respect for all religions and women; people-oriented
- Skilled in selecting talent and building loyal teams; discipline and strong intelligence network

Q2) Attempt any two (5 marks each) - all three solved

a) Explain Dharma, Raj Dharma and Artha.

- **Dharma:** righteous duty and moral order that supports society and individual life. It includes ethics, justice, duty according to one's role and stage of life (*svadharma*). In business: acting with integrity and responsibility to all stakeholders.
- **Raj Dharma:** the duty of a ruler or king (and by extension, a leader/manager). Includes protecting the people, giving justice, welfare of subjects, honest administration, taxing fairly (like a bee taking nectar), consulting advisers, and putting the public interest above personal interest. Source: Mahabharata (Shanti Parva),

Arthashastra, Manusmriti. In modern terms: good governance and leadership ethics.

- **Artha:** wealth, material resources and economic well-being, one of the four purusharthas (Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha). Indian thought accepts earning wealth but it must be by dharmic (ethical) means and for welfare of society. Kautilya's Arthashastra deals with economy, administration and statecraft.

Together: Artha should be earned following Dharma, and the ruler/leader must follow Raj Dharma.

b) Differentiate - Hierarchical structures vs Egalitarianism.

Basis	Hierarchical structure	Egalitarian structure
Authority	Top-down; clear chain of command with many levels	Shared authority; flat with few levels
Decision making	Centralised, by top management	Participative and decentralised
Communication	Vertical, formal and slow	Open, horizontal and fast
Status difference	High (power distance)	Low; all are treated as equals
Control	Strict rules and supervision	Trust and self-management
Advantages	Clarity of roles, discipline, control, suits large and routine tasks	Creativity, motivation, speed, employee satisfaction
Disadvantages	Slow, rigid, less innovation	Role confusion, delay in consensus, may lack control
Example	Army, government departments, traditional Indian family firms	Startups, Google, Valve, agile teams

c) Explain in detail the elements of ethical and efficient governance.

Governance means the system of directing and controlling an organisation (or state). **Ethical and efficient governance** contains the following elements:

Element	Meaning
Transparency	Open disclosure of decisions, information and finances; e.g. public reporting, RTI
Accountability	Leaders and officials are answerable for their actions and results; audits
Rule of law and fairness	Rules apply equally to everyone; no discrimination
Integrity and ethics	Honesty, avoiding corruption and conflict of interest; code of conduct (Raj dharma)
Participation and consultation	Involve stakeholders; Shivaji's Ashta Pradhan; consensus orientation
Responsiveness	Timely service to the needs of the stakeholders and grievance handling
Effectiveness and efficiency	Achieve goals with minimum use of resources; use of technology, clear roles and performance measures
Equity and inclusiveness	All sections benefit; protecting the weak (welfare)
Strategic vision and sustainability	Long-term view, protection of environment and future generations
Risk management and internal control	System for detecting and avoiding fraud and failures; independent board and audit committees

Indian examples: Kautilya's Arthashastra and Shivaji's administration, modern: SEBI's Corporate governance norms (Clause 49), Companies Act 2013.

Q3) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Explain the role of Shivaji Maharaj's leadership in contemporary management and leadership with examples.

Shivaji Maharaj's leadership offers many lessons for modern managers:

Leadership quality / practice of Shivaji	Contemporary management concept	Example
Clear vision of Swarajya, mission-driven	Vision and mission setting	A CEO sharing vision with employees (Steve Jobs, Tata)

Leadership quality / practice of Shivaji	Contemporary management concept	Example
Ashta Pradhan Mandal - council of ministers with defined portfolios	Delegation, decentralisation, functional organisation	Board of directors / department heads
Merit-based selection (Tanaji, Yesaji Kank, Hiroji), loyalty and trust	Talent management, team building	Hiring based on competence and culture fit
Guerrilla warfare, surprise and speed	Agile strategy, innovation, competitive advantage; 'strategy as an adaptive process'	Start-ups disrupting large competitors (Jio vs. telecom giants)
Forts and navy; intelligence system (Bahirji Naik)	Environmental scanning, competitive intelligence, risk management	Market research and data analytics
Direct revenue system, support for farmers; no middlemen	Stakeholder orientation, fair practices, cost efficiency	Direct-to-farmer procurement (Amul, ITC e-Choupal)
Respect for women and all religions, strict discipline and punishment for wrong-doing	Ethical leadership, diversity and inclusion, code of conduct	Zero tolerance for misconduct (POSH) in companies
Resilience - escape from Agra, rebuilding after Purandar	Crisis management, resilience	Turnaround leaders (e.g. Tata Steel)
Navy and trade; self-reliance	Strategic foresight, entrepreneurship, self-reliance (Atmanirbhar Bharat)	Make in India

Conclusion: Shivaji's blend of vision, ethics, innovation, decentralisation and resilience is a model for contemporary leaders in business as well as in public administration.

b) Who is a Jugaad innovator? Compare with conventional innovation models.

Jugaad innovator: a person (often an ordinary entrepreneur, artisan, farmer or mechanic) who creates quick, low-cost, practical solutions using limited resources by improvising and being flexible. He or she focuses on the user's immediate problem and not on research or perfection. Examples: Mansukhbhai Prajapati (Mitticool clay fridge), Mohammed Saidullah, who created 'jugaad' vehicles, Arunachalam Muruganantham (low-cost sanitary pad machine), and local mechanics.

Basis	Jugaad innovation	Conventional (formal) innovation
Approach	Improvisation, flexible, quick fix	Systematic R&D, planned and structured process
Resources	Very limited, local and recycled	Large budget, labs, scientists, technology
Time	Very fast; trial and error	Long development cycle; stage-gate
Cost	Very low (frugal)	High investment
Focus	Immediate problem and affordability (needs of the poor)	Technology leadership, performance and brand
Quality / scale	Often uneven; difficult to scale and patent	High, standardised, scalable, IP protected
Risk	Low financial risk; high quality risk	High financial risk, lower failure of quality
Examples	Mitticool, motor-pump vehicles	Apple iPhone, Pfizer vaccines, Tesla

Conclusion: Jugaad is useful for emerging markets and resource scarcity, but needs to be combined with formal methods (quality, scale, IP) to become a sustainable innovation ('Jugaad + systematic = frugal innovation').

Q4) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Evaluate the role of intuition in decision making and propose strategies to manage it with data-driven methods.

Role of intuition: Intuition is the quick, unconscious judgement based on experience and pattern recognition. It is respected in Indian knowledge systems (*viveka, prajna*) and in modern research (Herbert Simon: 'intuition is analysis frozen into habit'; Daniel Kahneman's 'System 1').

Strengths of intuition

- Speed in situations with time pressure; useful when data is incomplete, unstructured or new (e.g. start-up decisions, crisis).

- Uses tacit knowledge and experience of experts (doctors, firefighters, chess players, traders); promotes creativity and vision (Steve Jobs).
- Considers human and ethical aspects that data may not capture.

Weaknesses

- Subjective, can be affected by biases (overconfidence, halo effect, confirmation bias, anchoring).
- Hard to explain, audit and replicate; risky for high-stake, complex decisions; not suitable for novices.

Strategies to manage intuition with data-driven methods

1. **Treat intuition as a hypothesis, then test it with data** (A/B testing, pilot, analytics, market research, scenario analysis).
2. **Use data to challenge bias:** devil's advocate, pre-mortem analysis and checklists; compare the decision with the base rate and historical performance.
3. **Structured decision process:** combine intuition with decision matrix, cost-benefit analysis or decision tree; record the reasoning for later review.
4. **Build analytics culture:** dashboards and KPIs; train managers in data literacy.
5. **Decision review / feedback:** track the results of intuitive decisions, learn from the errors, and improve the judgement.
6. **Use intuition where it works** (expert, familiar situations, quick decisions) and data for high-stake, repetitive, or big-investment decisions; use both in a 'human + AI' approach.

Conclusion: The best managers balance intuition and analytics - 'trust your gut, but verify with data'.

b) Discuss the implication of western work ethics on the organisational culture in India.

Western work ethic (Protestant work ethic - Max Weber) stresses hard work, individual achievement, punctuality, time management, professionalism, efficiency, a result- and performance-orientation, and a clear separation between personal and work life. **Indian work culture** traditionally emphasises relationships, hierarchy, family and community, flexibility, duty (*dharma*) and spirituality.

Positive implications

- **Professionalism and performance-orientation:** performance-based pay, KPIs, merit based promotion rather than favouritism.
- **Time discipline and efficiency:** deadlines, process orientation, productivity (IT sector, MNCs).
- **Transparency, ethics and corporate governance;** work-life policies and diversity.
- **Innovation and individual initiative;** flat structures and empowerment in several firms.

Negative / challenging implications

- **Individualism vs. collectivism:** excessive individual competition may reduce teamwork and loyalty valued in India.
- **Cultural conflict:** strict separation of professional and personal clashes with Indian relationship-based management and paternalism; high power-distance in India vs. low in the West.
- **Work stress and burnout:** a 'hustle culture' and long working hours; ignoring family/community obligations, festivals.
- **Over-emphasis on materialism and short-term results** which can weaken value-based practices such as *seva* and *nishkama karma*.

Way forward

Indian organisations should blend (**glocalise**): take professionalism, process and transparency from the West, and keep the Indian strengths of relationships, flexibility, spirituality and community values (e.g. Tata, Infosys's 'Indian values with global standards').

Q5) Attempt any one (10 marks) - both solved

a) Can family-owned business survive in today's competitive environment? Explain with example.

Yes, family-owned businesses can survive and grow in today's competitive environment, if they adapt. In India, family businesses (Tata, Birla, Reliance, Bajaj, Mahindra, Godrej) contribute a very large part of GDP and many have lasted for over 100 years.

Strengths that help survival

- **Long-term vision:** focus on generations, not on quarterly results.
- **Trust, loyalty and strong values:** stable relations with employees, suppliers and customers.
- **Quick decisions and flexibility;** concentrated ownership.
- **Patient capital and commitment;** deep knowledge of the market and brand reputation.
- **Community support and social capital.**

Challenges

- Succession and family disputes (e.g. Ambani split in 2005, Tata-Mistry conflict).
- Resistance to change, lack of professional management, nepotism.
- Mixing family and business matters; limited access to capital and technology; competition from MNCs and start-ups.

Strategies to survive (with examples)

- **Professionalisation:** appoint professional managers and independent directors (Tata Sons, Godrej).
- **Succession planning and family constitution** to avoid disputes.
- **Innovation and technology:** Reliance moved from textiles to petrochemicals, telecom (Jio) and retail; Mahindra moved from jeeps to EV and tech; Mamaearth, Haldiram's and Bikanervala have modernised sweets business with digital sales.
- **Diversification and global expansion;** professional governance and transparency, and keeping family values.

Conclusion: Family businesses survive if they combine traditional strengths (trust, values) with modern management and innovation.

b) Analyse the impact of emerging trends such as technology and globalisation on business.

Trend	Positive impact (opportunities)	Negative impact (challenges)
Technology (AI, automation, big data, IoT, cloud, e-commerce, digital payments)	Efficiency and lower cost; new products and business models (Uber, Zomato); better customer insights; wider market reach; remote work	Job loss from automation, cyber risk and data privacy, high investment, skill gap, digital divide; fast obsolescence
Globalisation (trade liberalisation, MNCs, global supply chains, FDI)	Larger markets and exports; access to technology, capital and talent; economies of scale; cost advantage (outsourcing - Indian IT/BPO); more choice for consumers	Intense competition from MNCs and imports; dependence on global shocks (COVID-19, wars, tariffs); cultural and regulatory complexity; inequality

Other impacts on business

- **Strategy:** need for agility, innovation, digital transformation and global strategy; shorter product life cycles.
- **Operations:** automation, global supply chain, just-in-time, resilience planning.
- **Marketing:** social media and online marketing, personalisation, global brand building.
- **HR:** skilled workforce, remote and gig work, reskilling; **finance:** fintech, global funding, foreign exchange risk.
- **Ethics and sustainability:** ESG expectations, data ethics, CSR.

Conclusion: Technology and globalisation offer big opportunities as well as threats. Businesses that adopt technology, innovate, develop their people and combine global thinking with local strength (including Indian knowledge and values) will succeed.